

Informed Consent Process

Effective Date: June 1, 2026 | Version 1.0

Purpose

This policy establishes Good Company's commitment to obtaining informed consent from every client before providing services. Informed consent ensures that clients (and where applicable, their representatives) fully understand the services they will receive, the limits of those services, their rights, and their financial obligations.

Definition of Informed Consent

Informed consent means that the client (or authorized representative) has been provided with clear, complete information about Good Company's services and has voluntarily agreed to receive those services. Informed consent includes understanding of:

- The specific services that will be provided
- The services that will NOT be provided (limits of scope)
- The pricing structure, billing terms, and refund policies, as described in the Payment Policy
- The client's rights, as described in the Client Rights Policy
- The conditions under which services may be terminated, as described in the Termination of Care Policy
- How personal information and records are handled, as described in the Records Retention Policy
- Emergency procedures
- How to voice concerns or complaints

Process Overview

The informed consent process consists of three phases:

1. Initial consultation: An in-person meeting where the client and family are introduced to Good Company's services, model, and policies
2. Document review: The client/family is provided with the Service Agreement and all relevant policies to review and acknowledge with signature at their own pace
3. Signed consent: The client (or authorized representative) signs the Service Agreement, indicating they have read, understood, and agreed to its terms

Initial Consultation

Before services begin, Good Company conducts a complimentary in-person consultation with the prospective client and (when present) family members. During this consultation:

- The client's needs, routines, and preferences are discussed
- Good Company's services are explained in detail
- The boundaries of service (non-medical, ambulatory clients only, etc.) are communicated
- Pricing structure is reviewed and the Payment Policy is provided in writing
- All written policies are made available
- Time is provided for questions and discussion
- Whether services are an appropriate fit is jointly determined

Documents Provided

Each prospective client receives the following documents during the consent process:

- Service Agreement (the primary consent document)
- Client Rights Policy
- Payment Policy
- Records Retention Policy
- Lifting & Transfer Assistance Policy
- Emergency Response Policy
- Elder Abuse Reporting Policy
- Complaint Handling Policy
- Termination of Care Policy
- Current price list
- Emergency contact information form
- Intake form (medical history, allergies, preferences, etc.)

Capacity to Consent

Good Company recognizes that some clients may have diminished capacity to provide their own informed consent due to cognitive impairment or other conditions. In such cases:

- Consent is obtained from the client's legally authorized representative (Power of Attorney, court-appointed guardian, or similar)
- Whenever possible, the client themselves is also included in the conversation and their preferences discussed
- Documentation of the representative's legal authority is maintained on file according to the Records Retention Policy
- The client's own preferences are documented and respected, even when consent is provided by a representative

Voluntary Consent

Consent must be given freely and without coercion. Good Company will not provide services if:

- The client expresses unwillingness to receive services
- There is evidence of coercion by a family member or other party

- The client (or representative) has not had adequate time to review the documents
- Questions or concerns have not been satisfactorily addressed

Ongoing Consent

Informed consent is an ongoing process, not a one-time event. The client retains the right to refuse any specific service at any time. Major changes to services or pricing require continued consent. Rate adjustments are communicated with at least 30 days' written notice, as described in the Payment Policy.

Right to Withdraw Consent

The client (or authorized representative) may withdraw consent and terminate services at any time, according to the Termination of Care Policy. No reason is required.

Documentation and Retention

Each consent is documented and retained in the client's file in accordance with the Records Retention Policy. Documentation includes:

- Signed Service Agreement
- Signed acknowledgment of Client Rights Policy
- Signed intake forms
- Documentation of any representative's legal authority (if applicable)
- Notes from the initial consultation
- Any subsequent updates or modifications to consent

Policy Review

This policy is reviewed annually. All staff members are required to read and acknowledge this policy.

Policy reviewed and approved by:



Natalie Perras, Owner

Date: 6/9/2026